

Analysis Summary: Vehicle Insurance Quotes in South Africa

Data source: Hippo.co.za, collected manually on 9 to 10 October 2026 **Tools:** Excel (cleaning), Power BI (dashboard) **Note:** Quotes are indicative prices, not offers of cover, and this is not financial advice.

1. Purpose

This analysis compares monthly vehicle insurance premiums across South African insurers, vehicle models and cover types, to see where the cheapest options sit and what drives the differences.

2. Data

- **82 usable quotes** from 10 insurers for 5 vehicles (all 2020 models) across 3 cover types.
- Every quote used the same driver details, address, parking setup, and private use.
- **Quotes by cover type:** 34 comprehensive, 24 third-party fire & theft, 24 third-party only.
- 68 further rows are recorded as N/A (56), Not recorded (10) or To verify (2). They have no price and are excluded from every calculation.

Vehicle	Variant
Toyota Hilux	2.4 GD S P/U S/C
VW Polo	GP 1.4 Trendline
Suzuki Swift	1.4 T Sport
Ford Ranger	2.0D XLT P/U D/C A/T
Toyota Corolla	1.6 Quest

3. Method

1. Quotes were entered by hand from the comparison site's results pages, one car and cover type at a time.
2. Prices and excesses were stored as numbers. Missing prices were left blank, never estimated.
3. Calculated columns: annual premium, price rank (1 is cheapest for that car and cover type), and saving versus the same insurer's comprehensive quote for the same car.
4. The dashboard slices the data by cover type and vehicle.

4. Results

4.1 Cover type drives price most

Cover type	Quotes	Lowest (R/month)	Highest (R/month)	Average (R/month)
Comprehensive	34	1,382	3,419	1,990
3rd Party, Fire & Theft	24	263	1,025	417
3rd Party Only	24	175	399	220

For the same insurer and car, the cheaper covers cost about **85% to 87% less** than comprehensive for Auto & General, Dialdirect, 1st for Women, Virseker and Budget Insurance, and about **82% less** for King Price. Momentum Insure's saving was about 63%, but that rests on a single comparison.

4.2 Comprehensive prices by vehicle

Vehicle	Quotes	Cheapest	Most expensive	Average
Toyota Hilux	8	R1,557 (Old Mutual)	R2,622 (King Price)	R1,890
VW Polo	9	R1,514 (Old Mutual)	R2,235 (Virseker)	R1,925
Suzuki Swift 1.4 T Sport	4	R2,031 (Absa)	R3,419 (King Price)	R2,516
Ford Ranger	9	R1,610 (Momentum Insure)	R3,225 (King Price)	R2,061
Toyota Corolla	4	R1,382 (Old Mutual)	R2,329 (King Price)	R1,650

Within a single car, the most expensive comprehensive quote was **48% to 100% higher** than the cheapest. The widest spread was on the Ranger (R1,610 to R3,225). The Swift's high prices partly reflect that it is a performance variant.

4.3 Who is cheapest

- **Comprehensive:** Old Mutual was cheapest on three of the five cars (Hilux, Polo, Corolla), Absa on the Swift and Momentum Insure on the Ranger. The Hilux was nearly a tie, with Old Mutual at R1,557 and Momentum Insure at R1,558.
- **Cheaper covers:** Auto & General, Dialdirect, 1st for Women, Virseker and Budget Insurance were the cheapest options on almost every car, with third-party fire & theft quotes averaging R344 and third-party only quotes R192.

- **Across all car and cover combinations:** Budget Insurance was cheapest most often (5 times), followed by Old Mutual and Auto & General (3 each), then King Price (2), and Absa, Momentum Insure and Virseker (1 each). Ties are counted for each tied insurer.

4.4 King Price

King Price was the most expensive comprehensive quote on every car where it was captured (average R2,899 across four cars). It was also the highest on the cheaper covers where other insurers quoted. On the Swift it was the only insurer to return cheaper-cover quotes (R431 and R290).

4.5 Premium and excess

- Auto & General, Dialdirect, 1st for Women and Virseker carried comprehensive excesses of R7,950 (Polo), R9,100 (Hilux) and R12,200 (Ranger). Budget Insurance's were slightly higher (R8,200, R9,350, R12,450). Excess rose with the vehicle.
- Absa's excess was R4,000 on all three cars it quoted, Momentum Insure's R6,000, Old Mutual's and Iwyze's R6,200, and King Price's R7,500.
- The lowest comprehensive premiums on most cars came from insurers with lower excesses (Old Mutual, Momentum Insure, Iwyze), so a cheaper premium did not always mean a higher excess. The budget-focused brands were mid-priced on comprehensive but combined that with high excesses.

4.6 Insurer coverage

Not every insurer quoted every car:

- King Price quoted in 14 of 15 car and cover combinations.
- Auto & General, Dialdirect, 1st for Women and Virseker quoted 11 each. None of them returned a quote for the Swift 1.4 T Sport.
- Old Mutual and Iwyze returned comprehensive prices only. Their price did not change when the cover filter changed, so those rows are treated as N/A for the cheaper covers.
- Absa returned quotes on three cars, comprehensive only.

5. Conclusions

1. **Choose the cover type before the insurer.** The gap between cover types (roughly 5 to 9 times) is far larger than the gap between insurers on the same cover.
2. **For comprehensive cover, compare several insurers.** The cheapest insurer changed by vehicle, and the spread within one car reached 100%.
3. **Look at excess as well as premium.** Excess ranged from R4,000 to R12,450 on comprehensive quotes, which affects what you pay when you claim.

4. **The cheapest cover is not the most complete.** Third-party covers cost a fraction of comprehensive but do not repair the insured vehicle in an at-fault accident. Cover terms were not compared in this analysis.

6. Limitations

- **One driver profile**, so the effects of age, gender, licence experience and claims history are not measured. Hippo's form uses the policyholder's own details, so other profiles could not be quoted honestly.
- **Indicative quotes** from one comparison site, collected over two days. Prices can change and the site's own results varied slightly between runs (for example, Iwyze appeared in one Swift run and not in the re-run).
- **Uneven insurer coverage**, so averages across insurers mix different car and cover combinations. Compare within one cover type and one vehicle.
- **Gaps in the data:** King Price on the Polo (comprehensive) and most of the Corolla comprehensive list were not captured. This affects the "cheapest" results for those cars. Budget Insurance's two Ranger cheaper-cover prices and a few excess values are also missing.
- **Swift variant:** the 1.4 T Sport is a performance model, so its prices are not typical of a standard Swift.
- **Budget Insurance bundles** shown on the Corolla results (Bundle 1 at R111 and Bundle 3 at R1,263) were excluded to keep one comparable price per insurer.
- **Small sample** of 82 quotes, so treat the results as an illustration rather than market-wide pricing.

7. Next steps

- Add more driver profiles (with the consent of the people concerned) to measure age, gender and claims effects.
- Repeat the collection on several dates to check how stable prices and rankings are.
- Capture the missing quotes and add more vehicles.
- Compare cover terms (such as excess structures and benefits), not just price.